Places in town: there is / there are

Nombre: _____ Fecha: _____

Qué vas a aprender

- Learn the names of places in a town
- Use there is with one thing and there are with more than one
- Make negatives and questions: there isn't, Is there...?
- Describe your town with prepositions of place

Para pensar

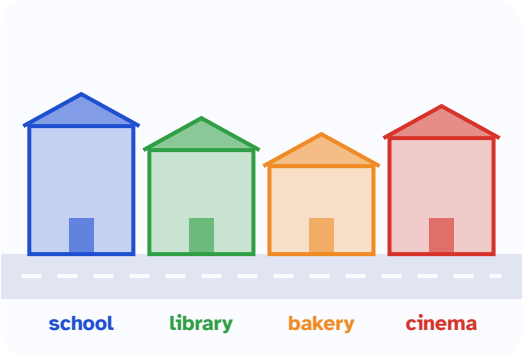
En español decimos «hay un parque» y «hay dos parques», con la misma palabra. ¿Pasa lo mismo en inglés?

Explicación

Places in town

Let's learn the places in a town: **school**, **park**, **library** (biblioteca), **hospital**, **supermarket**, **bakery** (panadería), **post office** (correos), **police station** (comisaría), **train station** (estación de tren), **cinema**, **museum**, **swimming pool**, **restaurant**, **café** and **bank**.

Ojo con los falsos amigos: *library* no es «librería», es **biblioteca**. Una librería es un *bookshop*. Y *pharmacy* o *chemist's* es la farmacia.



There is: one thing

We use there is (short form: **there's**) to say that **one** thing exists in a place: «**There's a** park near my house», «**There is a** big tree in the square», «**There's an** old castle in my town».

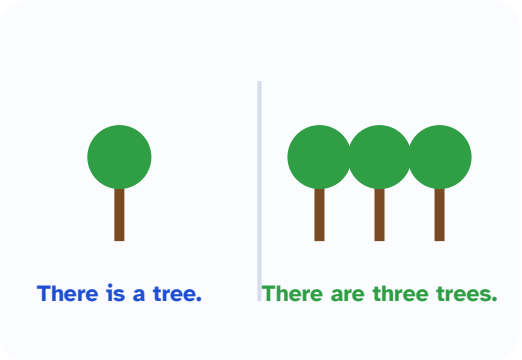
After *there is* we usually put **a** or **an**. We also use it with things we can't count: «There's some water in the bottle». **En castellano:** *there is* = «hay» cuando hablamos de una sola cosa.



There are: more than one

We use there are for **two or more** things: «**There are** three schools in my town», «**There are some** shops in my street», «**There are** lots of trees in the park».

The noun goes in **plural**: schools, shops, trees. The short form *there're* exists, but it's not common in writing. **Truco:** mira lo que viene después. ¿Es una cosa? → *is*. ¿Son varias? → *are*. «There **is** a cinema. There **are** two cinemas.»



Negatives: there isn't, there aren't

To say that something **doesn't exist**, add **not**: there isn't (there is not) and there aren't (there are not). «There **isn't a** zoo in my town», «There **aren't any** mountains near Valladolid».

With *there aren't* we usually use **any**: «There aren't **any** museums». **En castellano:** «no hay» se dice *there isn't* para una cosa y *there aren't any* para varias. Fíjate: en las afirmativas usamos *some*, y en las negativas, *any*.



Questions: Is there...? Are there...?

For questions, we change the order: Is there a bank near here? Are there any parks in your town? The short answers are: «Yes, there is. / No, there isn't.» and

«Yes, there are. / No, there aren't.»

To ask about numbers: «**How many** schools **are there** in your town?» – «There are two». **En castellano:** «¿Hay un banco cerca?» → «Is there a bank near here?». Es muy útil cuando estás de viaje y buscas algo.



Where is it? Prepositions of place

To say **where** places are, we use prepositions: **next to** (al lado de), **opposite** (enfrente de), **between** (entre), **behind** (detrás de), **in front of** (delante de), **near** (cerca de) and **on the corner** (en la esquina).

Examples: «The bakery is **next to** the bank», «The library is **opposite** the park», «The café is **between** the cinema and the school». **Consejo:** dibuja un mapa sencillo y practica con flechas; las preposiciones se aprenden mejor viéndolas.



Town or city?

A **village** (pueblo pequeño) is small: there are a few houses, a church and maybe a shop. A **town** is bigger: there are schools, shops, a market and a library. A **city** (ciudad) is very big: there are lots of buildings, an airport, big hospitals, museums and a lot of traffic.

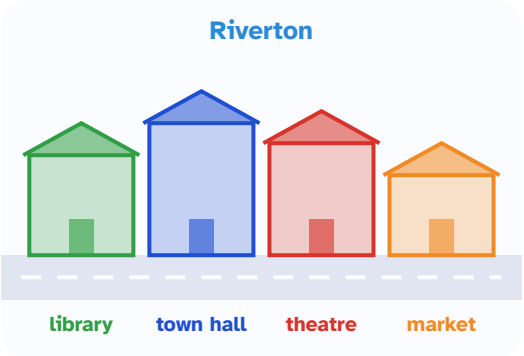
Describing where you live: «I live in a **village** near Teruel. There's a small square and there are two cafés. There isn't a cinema, but there's a swimming pool in summer». **Pregunta:** ¿tú vives en un village, en un town o en una city?



Reading: welcome to Riverton

Read Ella's text: «I live in Riverton, a small town near the sea. There's a beautiful beach and there are lots of fish restaurants. In the centre **there's** a square with a fountain. The library is **opposite** the town hall. **There are** two schools and a sports centre. **There isn't** a cinema, but **there's** a theatre next to the market. **There aren't any** tall buildings. I love my town!»

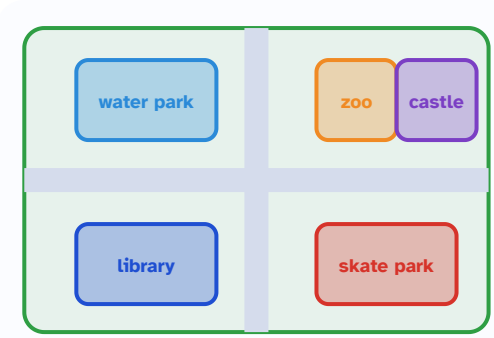
Answer: Is there a cinema in Riverton? Where is the library? How many schools are there?



Let's practise: design your dream town

Draw a map of your **dream town** (pueblo ideal). Add at least eight places: maybe a chocolate factory, a skate park or a giant library! Then write a description: «In my dream town **there is** a big water park. **There are** three ice cream shops. The zoo is **next to** the castle. **There isn't** any traffic: people go by bike».

Swap maps with a partner and ask questions: «**Is there** a football stadium?», «**How many** parks **are there**?». **Consejo:** comprueba que usas *is* con una cosa y *are* con varias.



There is / there are

one thing

THERE IS

There's a park.
There isn't a zoo.

more than one

THERE ARE

There are two shops.
There aren't any.

questions

IS / ARE THERE?

Is there a bank?
Yes, there is.

where?

PREPOSITIONS

next to · opposite
between

Ejercicios

1. **Translate: biblioteca, panadería, comisaría, estación de tren.**

2. **Complete with is or are: «There ___ a cinema.»**

3. **Complete with is or are: «There ___ five parks.»**

4. **Make it negative: «There is a museum.»**

5. **Make a question: «There are some cafés.»**

6. **Short answer (yes): «Is there a bank near here?»**

7. **Translate: «La farmacia está enfrente del colegio.»**

8. **What's the difference between a village and a city?**

9. **Correct: «In my street have two shops.»**

10. **Write three sentences about your town.**

Practica

1. **«Hay un parque» is...**

   A) There are a park.

   B) It has a park.

   C) There is a park.

2. **«There ___ three schools.»**

   A) are

   B) is

   C) be

3. **«Library» means...**

   A) librería

   B) biblioteca

   C) laboratorio

4. **«There aren't ___ museums.»**

   A) some

   B) any

   C) a

5. **Which question is correct?**

   A) There is a bakery?

   B) Are there a bakery?

   C) Is there a bakery?

6. **Short answer: «Are there any parks?» (no)**

   A) No, there aren't.

   B) No, there isn't.

   C) No, they aren't.

7. **«Opposite» means...**

   A) al lado de

   B) detrás de

   C) enfrente de

8. **«Between» means...**

   A) cerca

B) entre

C) encima

9. **«How many cinemas ___ there?»**

A) are

B) is

C) do

10. **A very big town with an airport is a...**

A) city

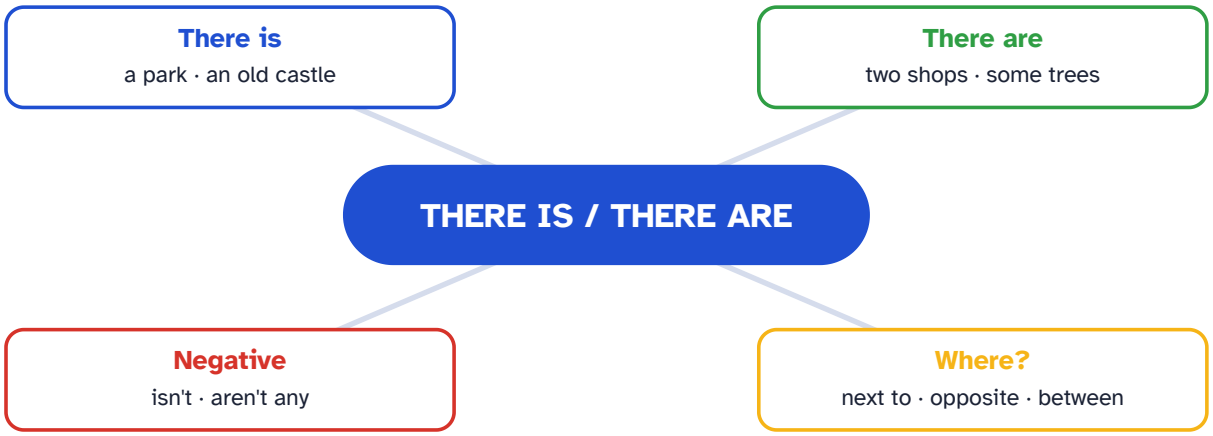
B) village

C) square

Explícalo con tus palabras

Incluye: Los lugares de un pueblo o ciudad en inglés; Cuándo se usa there is y cuándo there are; Cómo se hacen negativas y preguntas con there; Las preposiciones para decir dónde está un lugar.

Resumen



Tarjetas de repaso

Recórtalas: pregunta delante, respuesta detrás.

there is

Hay (una cosa).

there are

Hay (varias cosas).

there isn't

No hay (una).

there aren't any

No hay (ninguno).

Is there...?

¿Hay...? (una).

library

Biblioteca (no librería).

next to

Al lado de.

opposite

Enfrente de.

Soluciones

1. **C)** Uno: there is.
2. **A)** Plural.
3. **B)** Falso amigo.
4. **B)** Negativa: any.
5. **C)** Is there...?
6. **A)** Plural.
7. **C)** opposite.
8. **B)** between.
9. **A)** How many + are.
10. **A)** city.

Soluciones de los ejercicios

1. library, bakery, police station, train station.
2. is.
3. are.
4. There isn't a museum.
5. Are there any cafés?
6. Yes, there is.
7. The chemist's (pharmacy) is opposite the school.
8. A village is very small; a city is very big.
9. In my street there are two shops.
10. Model answer: There is a big park. There are two supermarkets. There isn't a zoo.